

and can't be changed at a later time. When installing an app, users are presented with the list of permissions requested by the app and can determine whether the permissions are appropriate for the functionality of the app. Permissions allow apps to access specific data and capabilities on a device, including location, contacts, SMS messaging, identity information, and the ability to access the internet. If an app's permissions seem overreaching, a user may choose not to install the app or may identify it as suspicious.



The App Store logo

The Android Market has a more community-based approach than Apple's App Store. Some security checks are performed when apps are submitted to the market, but it's expected that the community as a whole will participate in identifying malicious or otherwise undesirable apps. This allows Android developers to update their apps much more quickly than with Apple's curated model.

Threats to your mobile device

We can split mobile threats into four major categories – application-based threats, web-based threats, network-based threats and physical threats. Most of these threats are also common to computers. We've further split them into sub-categories.

1. **Application-based threats:** Just like the malicious software on PCs, apps present many security issues on mobile devices. These can be categorised in four ways:
 - a. **Spyware:** This is designed to collect or use data without a user's knowledge or approval. The most commonly targeted data is phone call history, text messages, location, browser history, contact list, email, and camera pictures. Spyware can be used to gather data from a particular group of people; eg. parents monitoring their child's phone. It can also be untargeted, designed to gather data about a large group of people. Targeted spyware apps are typically installed by somebody who has physical access to a victim's mobile device and there are a lot of commercial surveillance apps that can do this. Targeted spyware apps often have very legitimate use cases and are not always used maliciously.